

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Later Vedic source, chronology and eastward shift

RIGVEDIC LAYERS -> SAMAVEDA/YAJURVEDA/ATHARVAVEDA -> BRAHMANAS -> UPANISHADS
earlier NW world ritual corpora explanation reflection/critique
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broad c. 1000-600 BCE: Punjab/upper Ganga-Yamuna -> Kuru-Panchala -> Kosala-Videha
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Textual sequence is relative and layered; it is not an annual political chronicle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Forest-agriculture-iron-surplus mechanism

forest edge + alluvial soils + rainfall + growing labour organisation

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iron in expanding use + heavier ploughing + cattle traction + crop diversification

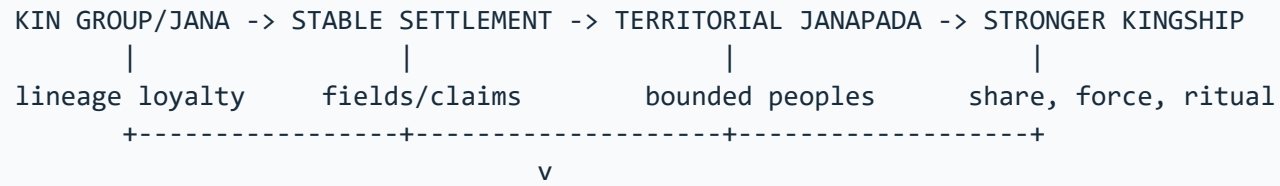
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stable fields/surplus -> larger settlements -> crafts -> political extraction

CAUTION: iron helped within an ecological-social package; it did not create states alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Jana to janapada: territorial political change



Assemblies persist but lose relative weight; monarchy grows without instant bureaucracy.
This bridges to Mahajanapadas, but no inevitable one-way state ladder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Later Vedic political institution system

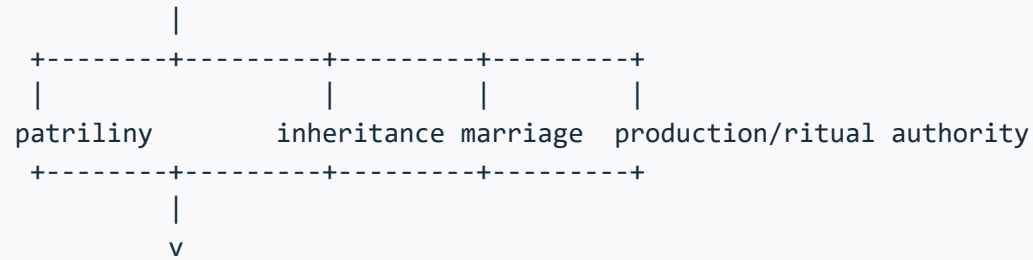
RAJAN

- |-- ratnins: politically and ritually significant figures
- |-- purohita: legitimation | senani: force | gramani: local linkage
- |-- sabha/samiti: continued assemblies with changing influence
- |-- bali and ruler share: less regular than later taxation
- +> royal rituals advertise supremacy and mobilise elite consensus

Authority grows through territory, surplus, ritual and force together.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Household, gender, varna and social ordering

GRIHAPATI-CENTRED HOUSEHOLD



varna firms: Brahmana authority + Kshatriya power + producers + servants

Gender constraints grow in many texts; female seers/debaters prevent a uniform claim.

Gotra expands; later jati and full four-ashrama scheme require caution.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Sacrifice as political economy

SURPLUS + SPECIALISED PRIESTS + ROYAL AMBITION

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RAJASUYA: consecration | ASHVAMEDHA: sovereignty | VAJAPEYA: power/prestige

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redistributes gifts/animals

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ranks ruler, priests and participants

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Ritual stages, legitimises and negotiates power; it does not merely reflect it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Upanishadic turn: ritual transformed inward

PROBLEM: sacrifice promises results but leaves death, self and ultimate reality open.

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karma/rebirth + brahman-atman inquiry + knowledge as liberating discipline

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internalisation of sacrifice

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critique/reinterpretation of ritual monopoly

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Not total rejection: Upanishadic thought grows within and transforms Vedic tradition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Early versus Later Vedic comparison

AXIS	EARLY VEDIC	LATER VEDIC
space	Sapta-Sindhu/NW	upper Ganga-Yamuna/eastward
polity	jana, rajan, assemblies	janapada, kingship, ratnins
economy	cattle-centred mixed base	plough farming, surplus, crafts
society	flexible differentiation	firmer varna, patriarchy, gotra
religion	deity praise/yajna	royal rites + Upanishadic inquiry
material	mixed correlates	PGW useful; not an ethnic identity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Later Vedic answer architecture

10 MARKS: identify change -> mechanism -> Vedic term/ritual -> continuity caveat

15 MARKS: source/space -> economy -> polity -> society -> religion -> PGW caution

20 MARKS: eastward ecology -> iron/agriculture -> jana-janapada -> institutions

-> household/varna/gender -> sacrifice -> Upanishadic turn -> state bridge

Avoid iron-caused-kingdoms and women-lost-all-status claims; grade evidence.

CLOSE: territoriality, surplus and ritual hierarchy deepened cumulatively.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Identify Samhita, Brahmana, Aranyaka or Upanishad layer before inference.
2. Correlate PGW and iron by site and date without equating pottery with people.
3. Separate ritual prescription, political claim and uneven social practice.

VERDICT: Later Vedic change was gradual, regional and multi-causal.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Iron aided change but did not alone create agriculture, surplus or states.
2. Assemblies changed relative weight; they did not disappear everywhere at once.
3. Varna sharpened, but later jati and four-ashrama systems were not fully formed.

VERDICT: Use textual trends with archaeological and regional qualifications.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Route 2024 change and 2023 society-religion demands through parallel matrices.
2. Write source -> geography -> economy -> polity -> society -> ritual -> thought.
3. End with continuity, transition and a boundary before second urbanisation.

VERDICT: Agrarian territoriality deepened without a sudden pan-Indian revolution.